

canonicity. The human part in the transmission of the Text is obvious, but was there also divine activity, protecting the Text (including its exact wording)? And how might one ‘measure’ such divine activity? I see two relevant ‘tools’ to do the measuring: logic and history. I begin with the argument from logic.

Inspiration is a result or quality of Revelation—with that statement we are affirming that the Sovereign Creator decided to transmit some objective information to the human race. If the Creator was only concerned to transmit information to a given individual, or group, at a given point in time, for a specific purpose, it could be done orally. But if His purpose was to reach a sequence of generations (up to a thousand of them, 1 Chronicles 16:15), then the appropriate form would be in writing. Now then, if the Creator intended that His Revelation should arrive intact, or at least entire and in reliable condition, to the XXI century, He would absolutely have to watch over the process of transmission down through the centuries. He would have to forbid the irrecoverable loss of any genuine material, as well as forbid any unrecognizable insertion of spurious material. The original wording should be available, in whatever generation, to persons who were sufficiently interested in having that wording that they would pay the necessary price (time, travel, money) to obtain it. (In general, people would be satisfied with the wording they had, so long as they regarded it to be reliable.) So then, a person who believes in the divine inspiration of the NT, for example, should also believe in the divine preservation of the NT—it is a question of logic. But what about the historical evidences; do they agree with our logic, or do they not? To that question I now turn.

The Historical Evidence for Preservation

To begin, I submit that the following references may reasonably be understood as a statement by the Sovereign Creator that He intended to preserve His Text, but He gave no indication as to just how He proposed to do it. We must work back from what He did. But first, the references:

1 Chronicles 16:14-15 is part of a psalm of praise to God that was sung when the Ark was brought to Jerusalem. “He is the LORD our God; His judgments are in all the earth. Remember His command forever, the word which He commanded for a thousand generations.” For the Word to be binding until the thousandth generation, it would have to be preserved until that generation, and it would need to be available to each generation along the way. I take it that “a thousand generations” is parallel to “forever”. “Forever, O LORD, Your word is settled in heaven. Your faithfulness is to all generations” (Psalm 119:89-90). “Forever” is parallel to “all generations”. “The grass withers, the flower fades, but the word of our